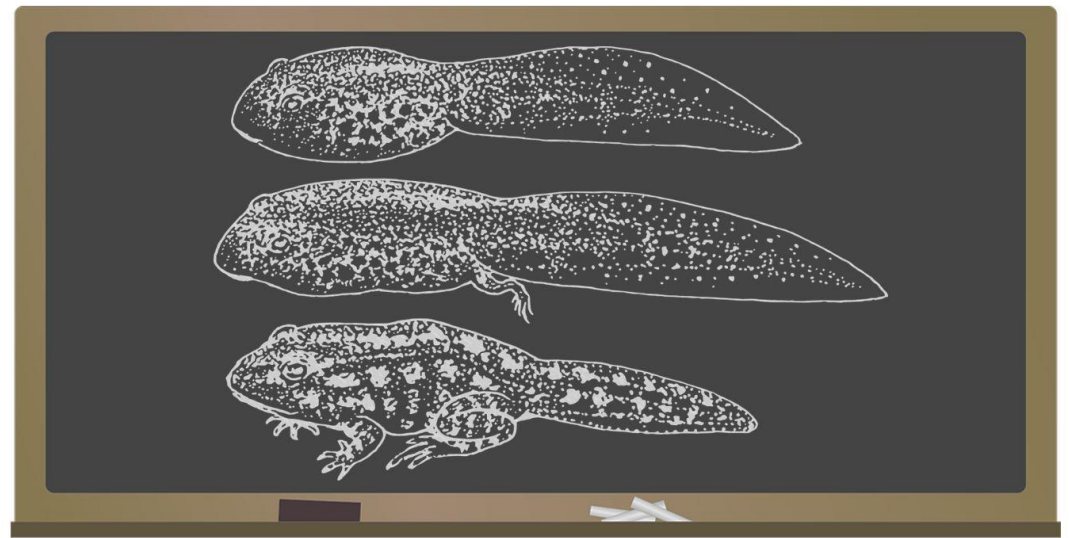
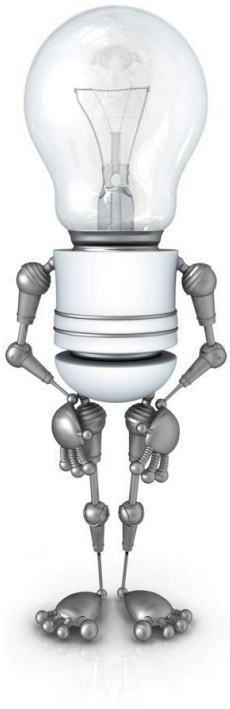




Change Management Workbook

Ei4Change

Change Management Workbook

Change Management

This workbook helps you to look at some actions or activities that you can take to manage change more effectively within your role and within your current situation.

Often change is not managed well. People up and down the chain of command can be too resistant, too reactive and too closely tied to old management habits.

During times of transition and change, it's not business as usual. Your responsibilities as a manager or leader takes on a new dimension, especially if your organisation is being acquired, merged, restructured or downsized. You have to handle your usual day to day duties, *and* you have to manage the change process itself. Suddenly, your job has grown. It's more complex. You have more things to consider, plus you will find that some of your old habits and routines in the way you manage employees just won't work.

Here are some strategies for you to consider. The strategies focus on specific management steps that you can take to manage change, instead of letting change manage you. These strategies will support your performance and the performance of others during transition and change.

For each strategy consider some actions and activities you can take within your role and within the current situation.

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Be a Change Agent

Success in this environment requires flexibility and adaptability. If the rate of change in the organisation exceeds your own rate of change as a manager, you're going to encounter problems. New developments in the way work is conducted call for new behaviours. Keep up with what's happening around you by changing your approach and your emphasis.

Adapt to the environment as it changes. Flexibility is one of the key solutions to being a good change agent.

What actions or activities can you take?

Change Management Workbook

Promise Change... and Sell It (Carefully)

Part of being a responsible manager is preparing your people for change. The future is going to be different. Your people need to know that. Promise change - because that's a promise you can keep. You are responsible for helping to sell the changes as a part of the management team. It is not all about the positive aspects of the changes and how wonderful things are going to be. Employees should be given a balanced viewpoint. Usually there is good news and bad news and both sides should be communicated. So, let people know what they can expect and tell them honestly.

What actions or activities can you take?



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Get Resistance to Change Out in the Open

You can expect a certain amount of resistance. Certain employees will not readily embrace the changes. The key to managing resistance effectively is to invite it. Get it out into the open. This gives you the chance to analyse it and work towards managing it better. Sometimes you can reduce the resistance by giving people a good understanding of the rationale and reasons for the changes. If they are given a clear understanding of what the alternatives were and the options that were considered, it often becomes easier for them to buy into the situation.

Keep in mind that resistance may indicate that something is not being done right. Maybe you need to change the way that you are operating. Ask yourself if you're providing the right role model. Is your own resistance to change too obvious? Perhaps you need to tell higher management that certain changes aren't working.

What actions or activities can you take?

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Keep a Positive Attitude

Your attitude as a manager or leader will be a major factor in determining what the climate is within your work group. Your attitude is one of the few things that is totally under your control. The attitude and morale of your team will be influenced by your approach at this time.

Change can be disorientating, confusing and stressful. Be upbeat, positive and enthusiastic. The team will be more encouraged, which will make your job as a manager a lot easier. The circumstances will really test your ability to perform as a leader and people will be looking to you to be the right kind of role model.

What actions or activities can you take?

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Don't Give Away Your Power

Managers and leaders frequently become more tentative during times of significant organisational change. They grow more cautious, more careful, and more uncertain about the extent of their authority and decision making. Giving away your power to higher management makes you less effective. Make decisions. Don't sit around waiting for permission. Instead, assume an active attitude. If you wait for clarity from above regarding what you can and can't do, your part of the organisation is going to lose momentum. Empower yourself.

What actions or activities can you take?



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Establish Clear Priorities

Some of the company's priorities will change and you will have to integrate these shifting priorities into your own work. Careful planning and organisation are essential. There will be many people and issues competing for your time. Make sure you focus on those things that are the most important. It is too easy for you to end up in a fire fighting mode, getting side-tracked by low priority issues. Make sure that you communicate your priorities clearly to others when you delegate work to them. Ensure that they have really understood these priorities.

What actions or activities can you take?



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Focus on Short-Term Objectives

Organisational change often means that you will have to lose resources within your work group. You may lose some of your people. This will lead you to having more work to do than before. Budget cuts may make it tougher to achieve what the company expects of you. One way of maximising effectiveness is to operate with clearly defined goals and objectives, especially over short periods of time. This enables you to get the best out of your people by keeping everyone focused on what they can achieve. Concentrate on quarterly, monthly or even weekly performance targets. Once established, you must do an equally good job of communicating them to the people who will be responsible for their achievement and the progress that is being made. Find opportunities to celebrate the group's achievements.

What actions or activities can you take?

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Give the Team Clear Instructions

Organisational change usually creates higher levels of uncertainty for employees. You need to manage in such a way that you minimise ambiguity and have as much clarity about the unknown as much as possible. Define duties and assignments in specific terms, rather than leaving things general and vague. Also, assign definite deadlines and timetables regarding when work is to be completed. It is all too easy to let things slip if the future is unknown. Clear guidance from you helps keep your people on track and will reduce the chances of them become less productive.

What actions or activities can you take?



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Define Each Person's Job Role

Work roles need clarification now. You can't assume that all employees know exactly where and how to aim their efforts. Meet with each of your employees to redefine their job responsibilities. Be very specific, especially on issues such as decision-making authority, personal accountability and reporting requirements. Ensure a precise understanding of the standards of performance they will be expected to achieve. Do this for everyone within your team. Clarify in writing, where possible. Manage any shortfalls in performance as they arise by assessing these against agreed functions of the role.

What actions or activities can you take?

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Raise Standards

While it may be most practical now to expect less in terms of how your team performs, you should ask for more. There is more now that needs to be done. In a more destabilised work environment, employees usually do some introspection. They examine their individual approach to the job, evaluate their careers and are more open to changing their work habits. Use this as an opportunity to push everyone to try harder and to work smarter. The performance standards you set and the objectives you put before your people should be challenging but not unrealistic. It is better for everyone's mental health and for company morale if people are kept busy with less time to worry about the future.

What actions or activities can you take?



Change Management Workbook

Rebuild Morale and Motivate

Significant organisational change destabilises the workforce. Change sometimes affects morale due to heavier workloads, job stress, feelings of insecurity, feeling unappreciated, frustration and confusion. These will be reflected in performance problems through apathy. The frustrations and job stress brought on by transition and change can be intense or they can go on for so long that employees lose their drive. You need to pay attention to your people. Help them to develop a sense of belonging and make them feel valued. You will, also, need to provide additional inspiration at times and use different motivational tactics on different people.

What actions or activities can you take?



Change Management Workbook

Encourage Risk-Taking and Initiative

Encourage the team to demonstrate more initiative and resourcefulness. Transition and change often make people feel insecure and uncertain. They become less willing to make decisions or take risks. People will prefer to play it safe, defer decisions or just wait to see what happens. They will be hesitant to embrace new work roles or tackle new assignments if they are uncertain regarding their own ability to make the changes. Help everyone to understand that you will be tolerant of mistakes, but intolerant of inertia, as you are looking for everyone to be independent thinking, decisive and action oriented.

What actions or activities can you take?



Change Management Workbook

Don't Try To Do Everything Yourself

Delegation is vitally important at this time. It can keep you from spreading yourself too thinly and gives your employees a sense of involvement, which encourages them to share responsibility for change. Good delegation enables your employees to feel a little more in control of circumstances and events. It adds to their sense of participation, giving them the feeling that they have more choices and more influence. As a result, they are likely to feel better about decisions that are made and will show more commitment in carrying them out.

What actions or activities can you take?

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Create a Supportive Work Environment

Change is accepted by people more readily in a safe environment. A psychologically supportive atmosphere makes people more willing to take risks and experiment with new ways of doing things. If your employees feel threatened, insecure or vulnerable, they become more inhibited. Give positive reinforcement to employees as soon as you see their work behaviour moving in the right direction, instead of waiting for them to get it perfect. Provide a work environment where they can comfortably practice the new skills or work approach without feeling that they are being critically judged or evaluated by you or their co-workers. Make it easy for them to experiment and ask questions without feeling stupid or incompetent.

What actions or activities can you take?

Change Management Workbook

Remain Astute and Aware

If the change is very complex or very involved, there will be some glitches, which will occur and become obvious very quickly. Careful monitoring and follow up are essential in order to prevent small issues from escalating into larger problems and to keep everyone on track. Check frequently to determine how well the changes are going or to see if the new approach is working. However, it is important not to micromanage.

What actions or activities can you take?



Change Management Workbook

Support Skill Development

People will more readily give up old methodologies and established practices if they have the knowledge and skills to do things the new way. It is your responsibility to ensure that the team gets the necessary education and training. You may need to function more as a teacher, trainer or coach and not just as a manager. Help your people fully understand the nature of the changes. Assist them in developing any new skills needed to perform competently.

What actions or activities can you take?



Change Management Workbook

Encourage and Compliment

At this time, it is unlikely that you are going to be in a position to offer tangible rewards. Increases in pay or benefits, for example, may not be possible. There is no limit to the intangible rewards you can provide for the extra effort required of them during times of transition and change. Don't underestimate the value employees place on simple things such as a word of thanks, encouragement or compliment from you. Give them a listening ear and show empathy. Ask their opinions about things. Call them by their name, ask them about their family, and say thanks when they demonstrate the right attitude and effort. Write a short memo to the employee expressing appreciation for quality work, timeliness, initiative, etc. When you hold meetings, single out individuals in public and give them a word of praise or commendation for good job performance.

What actions or activities can you take?

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Communicate

Communication is vital at this time. The normal communication channels probably won't be working as well as usual. Rumours spread very fast. Provide a variety of opportunities for employees share their thoughts and feelings and be a careful listener. Spend more time with people. Be available. Ask more questions. Get their opinions and reactions to the changes. Maintain more visibility.

The other part of good communication is getting the information to your people that they want and need. Keep employees updated on a regular basis. Telling them that you don't have any new information is meaningful information to them. Strive to be specific rather than vague, candid rather than guarded. Clear up any rumours and misinformation. It is almost impossible for you to over-communicate during times of transition and change.

What actions or activities can you take?



Change Management Workbook

Go Looking for Bad News

Find out about and face up to any problems and aggravations that occur. The solution to one problem can often generate a new set of problems requiring additional solutions. Expect trouble. Problems will be out there, somewhere. If you're not aware of any issues, that is a problem in itself. Get in touch with your department. Invite bad news. If your people say there is a problem, then take it seriously. They see things that you can't see, and they look at the things you can see in a different light than you do. Their perspective may be better than yours. You need to know what you're up against. You can't lead if you're the last one to know. Make it easy for people to tell you those things you don't necessarily want to hear. Discipline yourself to reward people who identify problems and report organisational breakdowns.

What actions or activities can you take?

Change Management Workbook

Protect Quality and Customer Service

During organisational transitions, it is easy to lose your clients. You may lose some of your best trained staff or you may have new people doing things in new ways. In the process, the quality of products and services can fall. Some employees may resent what the company has done, how it has changed things and try to fight back or to get even by putting in less effort. Others lose corporate pride and they just don't care so much anymore. At this time, it is important to uphold the standards for product quality and customer service. Inspect more closely. Stay close to your customers. That way you'll know if your firm's products or services are slipping in quality. Even if your department doesn't have direct customer contact, you're serving other work groups who do. Change may be taking place, but the need for satisfied customers never changes.

What actions or activities can you take?



Change Management Workbook

Reconnect With Your Good People

A destabilised corporate environment can be a threat to employees' careers. Sometimes they grow weary of the uncertainty regarding the future and decide to seek their fortunes elsewhere. Typically, they are more willing than usual to consider job opportunities offered by other firms. The worst part of this problem is that some of the most talented are the first to go. This can drain your work group of its most capable people at the very time when you need good performers more than ever. That's why you should move quickly to reconnect with your good people. Do this with the same intensity that would be invested in recruiting an outsider to join your company. Tell them you want them. Make them feel important. It's high risk management to assume that your key players are going to remain on the team just because they haven't publicly announced that they plan to leave.

What actions or activities can you take?



Change Management Workbook

Take Care of How Change Affects People Individually

Every employee looks at how organisational change will personally affect them. It raises big questions in each person's mind such as: Will I get to keep my job? How will my pay and benefits be affected? Will this affect my opportunities for advancement? Will I have a new boss? What will be expected of me now?

Until important questions like these can be answered satisfactorily, employees are too preoccupied with their own situations to focus effectively on their work. Company interests take a back seat to personal interests. People worry, gossip and share rumours rather than concentrate on their jobs. Get questions about how people are going to be personally affected answered as soon as possible so they can get on with business.

The emotions that you will have to manage cover a broad spectrum of feelings. These are going to be experienced by you as well as your employees. Emotions will range from anxiety, distrust, self-pity, frustration, denial, anger, depression and guilt and may change rapidly and without reason. Be tolerant of these emotions and how they are shown, even when some of the hostility gets directed at you. Provide opportunities for people to express their emotions appropriately.

Change Management Workbook

What actions or activities can you take?

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Change Management Workbook

Reduce the Level of Job Stress

Make an effort to minimise surprises as much as possible. Give people advance warning about what's coming next and allow more time for them to get ready mentally.

It also helps reduce job stress when you keep a sense of humour. Bring some fun into the work environment. Even when things are frustrating and aggravating, you probably can help the situation by poking fun at it. If you allow a sense of play, it can prevent things from getting depressingly serious.

What actions or activities can you take?

Change Management Workbook

Be Supportive of Higher Management

Just as you need the support of your employees, your managers and leaders are also going to need your support. Make sure that your work group's efforts are aligned with your manager's goals and objectives. Be strongly aware of his or her priorities and adjust yours accordingly. Be forgiving of errors by higher management. What you consider a mistake may be precisely the right move or at least the best move under the circumstances. Keep in mind that higher management can see things from a different perspective and they usually have access to important information that you don't have. This is not an argument for blind loyalty on your part, but rather for willingness to give your leaders the benefit of the doubt.

Report problems to more senior management. Don't give people higher in the chain of command an edited, sanitised version about the business. Report the truth, rather than hiding any shortcomings or glossing over problems that are developing or telling them what you think they want to hear. Sometimes you may be better informed than they are, and you will need to demonstrate managerial courage in confronting them and defending your convictions.

Ask for help. You can be a better employee yourself if you are not too proud or too afraid to let your manager know that you're having trouble.

Change Management Workbook

What actions or activities can you take?

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Change Management Workbook

Be More Than a Manager or Supervisor – Be a LEADER

Most organisations and work groups are managed, rather than led. This is a common problem in business but a particular problem in organisations confronted by transition and change. This is a great opportunity for you to develop your leadership qualities. During organisation transitions when things are confusing, stressful and generally destabilised, employees look for leadership.

It's easy enough for the company to put you in charge, to make you a manager. The company can't make you a leader - that's up to you. Being a good leader is a reputation and you have to earn it. The things you do, or don't do, determine what kind of leader you will be. This is precisely the time to become the leader you were born to be.

What actions or activities can you take?

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: +44 (0) 161 244 8884



: info@ei4change.com



: ei4change.com